

2026 Transformation Challenge | Weekly Email Content

WELCOME EMAIL



YOUR TRANSFORMATION CHALLENGE STARTS NOW

[NAME],

You've already completed the first step: getting signed up! Now, it's time to get pumped — get ready for six weeks of Coach-approved training, nutrition, and recovery guidance to help you crush your goals.

Next steps:

1. **Get an Evolt scan:** Talk with a Coach to schedule a baseline fitness consultation and [Evolt 360 body composition scan](#). This will give you real data to help you set goals and track your progress for the next six weeks. [Click here](#) to book your fitness consultation.
2. **Check your inbox:** Once a week, we'll send can't-miss training, nutrition, and recovery tips from our Coaches straight to your inbox. Think of it like a personal trainer in your back pocket!
3. **Get to work (and possibly win a prize!):** It's called a challenge for a reason — you're going to be asked to push yourself to the next level, and it will be worth it. Not to mention: You could win one of several prizes.*

To earn prize entries post your Transformation Challenge journey to Instagram:

1. Share a picture or video of your Transformation Challenge experience on Instagram

2. Use the hashtags **#AnytimeFitness** and **#sweepstakes** and follow [@anytimefitness on IG](#)
3. Post between Feb 2 and March 27.

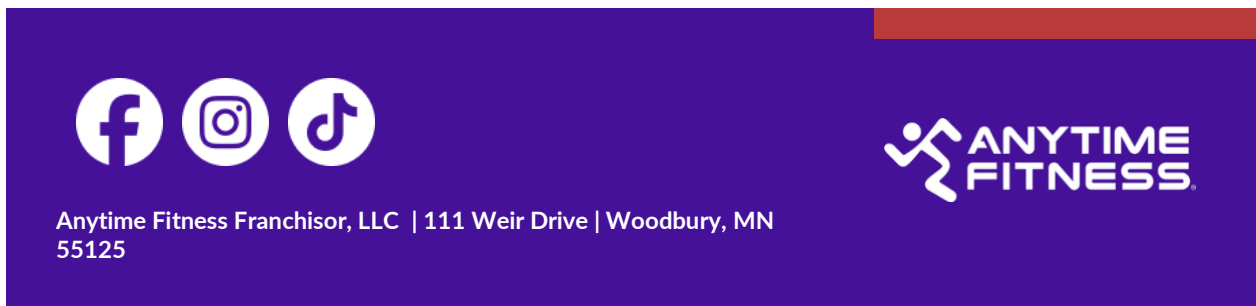
You'll get one entry per post, up to 10 total entries. (Note: Your profile must be public.)

Prizes include:

- **Grand prize:** One 7-day trip for two to anywhere in the world where there's an Anytime Fitness.
- **Other prizes include:** Year-long Anytime Fitness memberships, recovery tools, AF swag and more.

[Click here](#) for more information on prizes and sweepstakes rules.

Ready? Let's do this!



*NO PURCHASE NECESSARY. Legal residents of the 50 U.S. (D.C.) 18 years or older. Ends 3/27/26. see [Official Rules](#), including entry requirements, mail in entry, prize details & odds Void where prohibited.

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YOUR WEEK 1 TRANSFORMATION CHALLENGE LINEUP

Hey, [NAME]!

Welcome to week 1 of the Transformation Challenge! Over the next six weeks, we're sharing Coach-approved training, nutrition, and recovery tips to help you hit your goals.

TRAINING

If you haven't already, [download the AF App](#) ! There, you can kick off your journey with the Strength Assessment workout. Regular assessments help track your progress, identify areas of improvement, and set brand new goals. The Assessment also customizes the weight recommendations in your app workouts moving forward, so you can take the guesswork out of your training plan.

Chat with your Coach today and make a plan to complete your Strength Assessment and keep pushing forward!

NUTRITION

Wondering what to eat before your workout? Some sources say eat nothing, others insist on carbs, and then there are those pushing protein. The truth is: It's a bit of a mixed bag — and that's because the right snack depends on your specific performance goals, workout intensity, and personal preference.

According to Coach Gianna, our registered dietitian extraordinaire, the key is understanding your workout intensity. For lighter workouts like a brisk walk or yoga session, a small snack rich in carbs and a hint of protein can provide the energy you need without weighing you down. Here are some examples:

- Banana with a spoonful of nut butter
- Yogurt parfait with granola
- Apple slices with cheese

- Whole-grain crackers and hummus

If you're gearing up for a sweat-soaked HIIT session, heavy weight day, or a long run, amp up the carbs a bit more to fuel those muscles. Opt for whole grains like oatmeal with berries or whole grain toast with cottage cheese. These snacks provide sustained energy to keep you going strong.

Remember: It's not just about what you eat — it's also about when you eat it. Aim to have your snack about 30 minutes to an hour before your gym session. This gives your body time to digest and convert that fuel into pure workout power. ⚡

Bonus: Remember your Evolt scan results? You can also use your personalized macro breakdown to plan your pre-workout snacks. For example: If your macro plan requires a little more protein than usual, try some beef jerky or a hard-boiled egg with toast!

📖 RECOVERY

Stretching isn't just for yogis and pro athletes — it's key to keeping your body happy, healthy, and ready to take on the next five weeks! Try these three stretches to feel your best:

Hamstring stretch

[For more on hamstring stretches, click here.](#)

Why we do it: Tight hamstrings can contribute to tight hip mobility, poor exercise form, and lower back pain. This stretch improves the flexibility of the hamstring muscles, hip mobility, and reduces the risk of injury during activities like running or lifting.

How to:

1. Lie on your back with both knees bent, feet on the floor.
2. Next, straighten one leg toward the ceiling and gently grab below the knee at the back of the thigh.
3. Slowly pull your leg toward you and hold the stretch for 45 seconds or until you feel the hamstring start to relax.

Pro tip: If you roll your shoulders forward to grab your leg, loop a towel or band around your forefoot and hold the ends to support the weight of your leg. This allows your upper body to stay relaxed.

Chest stretch

[Watch the tutorial in the AF app!](#)

Why we do it: In our tech-driven world, hunching over screens has become the norm. This can tighten chest muscles and round shoulders, leading to poor posture, neck pain, and even compromised breathing. This stretch counteracts poor posture, alleviates neck pain, and improves breathing by opening up the front of your body.

How to:

1. With the side of your body facing a wall, place one palm on the wall at shoulder height and step forward with the leg closest to the wall.
2. Keep your elbow slightly bent and gently press your palm into the wall to protect the shoulder.
3. Slowly rotate your torso away from the wall until you feel the stretch in your chest.
4. Hold for 45 seconds or until you feel the chest muscles start to relax. Then repeat on the other side.

Hip flexor stretch

[Watch the tutorial in the AF app!](#)

Why we do it: Sitting for long periods can lead to tight hip flexors, which can contribute to lower back pain and affect posture. Stretching the hip flexors improves flexibility, reduces tension, and supports better hip mobility.

How to:

1. Kneel on your left knee with your right foot placed flat on the ground
2. The right knee should be stacked directly above the right ankle.
3. Keep your spine long and tall, and engage your core while squeezing your right glute to stretch the right hip.
4. Hold the stretch for 45 seconds or until you feel the hip muscles relax, then switch sides.

Pro tip: If this is uncomfortable for your knee, you can also do the same stretch standing up in a split stance.

Incorporate these three stretches into your daily routine to maintain flexibility, prevent injuries, and promote relaxation. Remember to breathe deeply and listen to your body — stretching should feel good, not painful.

Ready to put these tips into practice? We know you can do it! Check in next week for even more training, nutrition, and recovery advice to keep your momentum going.



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YOUR WEEK 2 TRANSFORMATION CHALLENGE LINEUP

Hey, [NAME]!

One week down! 🏋️ Let's keep the momentum going with even more expert Coaching tips.

🏋️ TRAINING

We get it — life can be a whirlwind, and getting a workout in is sometimes easier said than done. But we're here to help you make every second of your Transformation Challenge count! When time is tight, try these full-body moves for a workout that really packs a punch. Perform 3-4 sets of 10-12 reps of each exercise.

Squat press

Why we love it: The squat press engages multiple muscle groups, including the legs, glutes, shoulders, and core. It not only improves strength and power in the lower body and upper body simultaneously, but also enhances coordination and stability due to the combined movement pattern!

How to:

1. Stand upright holding dumbbells or kettlebells at shoulder height, elbows bent, and palms facing in.
2. Bend at the hips and knees, lowering into a squat with the weights still at shoulder height.
3. Drive the hips forward and up, coming back upright, and press one weight overhead, extending your arm fully.
4. Lower the weight back to the shoulders and repeat with the opposite arm.

Mountain climbers

Why we love them: Mountain climbers are a great full-body exercise that increases

cardiovascular fitness and agility. Improves explosive power and endurance? Check!
Effective for burning calories and improving overall conditioning? Check!

How to:

1. Begin in a high plank position with your hands directly under your shoulders and your body in a straight line from head to heels. Look slightly ahead of you to keep your neck in line with your spine.
2. Engage your core by pulling your belly button toward your spine while keeping your back flat and hips level.
3. Bring one knee toward your chest, keeping the other leg extended. Alternate legs in a quick, controlled manner, as if you're running in place.
4. Maintain a steady breathing pattern. Inhale and exhale rhythmically to keep oxygen flowing and prevent fatigue.

Plank to high plank

Why we love it: This exercise strengthens the shoulders, chest, arms, and most of all, the core. A stronger core supports better posture and reduces the risk of lower back pain — a win, win!

How to:

1. Raise your body off the floor, resting on your toes and forearms.
2. Straighten your arms, one at a time, coming up into the top of a push-up position and hold briefly.
3. Lower yourself back to your forearms, one arm at a time.
4. Repeat, alternating sides with each rep.

When you're short on time, these exercises provide a full-body workout that can be done virtually anywhere with a set of weights. Don't have dumbbells? Grab a milk jug or other bottle and fill it up! Whether you have 10 minutes or 30, these movements can help you stay on track with your goals and ready to tackle whatever life throws your way.

Need some extra help with form or modifications? Looking for additional compound movements? Ask your Coach!

NUTRITION

As you progress through the Transformation Challenge, you may notice fluctuations in your body weight that can sometimes seem puzzling. Here's a breakdown of why these fluctuations may occur and what they mean in the context of your wellness journey:

1. Water retention

Cause: Intense workouts or changes in diet can cause temporary water retention. Sodium intake, hormonal changes, and muscle repair processes can also play a role.

Impact: This can lead to short-term weight fluctuations that may not reflect actual fat loss or gain. It's a natural part of the body's response to new routines.

2. Muscle gain vs. fat loss

Cause: As you increase physical activity, you may simultaneously lose fat and gain muscle. Muscle is denser than fat, so even as your body composition improves, the scale might not show immediate changes.

Impact: This can result in fluctuations where you might weigh the same or more than before, despite looking leaner and feeling stronger. Trust the process — muscle gain is beneficial for metabolism and overall health.

3. Digestive changes

Cause: Altering your diet or starting new fitness routines can affect digestion and bowel movements. Variations in fiber intake and hydration levels can impact your weight day-to-day.

Impact: Fluctuations due to digestive changes are temporary and are likely to normalize as your body adjusts to new eating habits and exercise routines.

4. Stress and sleep

Cause: Stress hormones like cortisol can influence weight retention, particularly around the midsection. Inadequate sleep can also disrupt hormone levels and metabolic processes.

Impact: Managing stress through relaxation techniques and prioritizing quality sleep can help stabilize weight fluctuations caused by stress-related factors. We'll be looking into this more next week — stay tuned!

5. Measurement inconsistencies

Cause: Differences in weighing scales, timing of measurements (e.g., morning vs. evening), and clothing worn during weigh-ins can affect recorded weight. Your weight can fluctuate by 1–5 pounds in 24 hours!

Impact: Focus on long-term trends rather than daily fluctuations to gauge progress accurately. Use consistent methods and conditions for measurements to track changes effectively.

Understanding why your body weight fluctuates during your fitness journey can help you stay motivated and focused on your goals. Stay the course, trust the process. Remember, weight is just one measure of progress — how you feel, your energy levels, and improvements in strength and endurance are equally important indicators of success.

RECOVERY

In the hustle and bustle of our daily lives, finding moments to prioritize mental wellness can make a world of difference — especially when it comes to achieving your health goals. Stress can affect everything from cravings to metabolism.

Here's how meditation and specific breathing techniques can help you create that essential space for mental well-being and support your journey through the Transformation Challenge and beyond.

1. Mindfulness meditation

Technique: Find a quiet space, sit comfortably, and focus on your breath. Notice each inhale and exhale without judgment. When thoughts arise, gently bring your attention back to your breath. Want more direct guidance? Activate your [free access to an Apple Fitness+ subscription](#) today for a full library of guided meditations!

Why it helps: Mindfulness meditation reduces stress by calming the mind and promoting relaxation while enhancing self-awareness.

2. Box breathing

Technique: Inhale deeply through your nose for a count of 4 seconds. Hold your breath for 4 seconds. Exhale slowly through your mouth for 4 seconds. Hold your breath again for 4 seconds. Repeat this cycle for several minutes.

Why it helps: Box breathing regulates the nervous system, promoting a state of calmness and reducing the production of stress hormones like cortisol. It can be done anywhere and anytime stress levels rise (even at your desk 😊).

3. Progressive muscle relaxation (PMR)

Technique: Start by tensing and then relaxing each muscle group, one by one, starting from your toes to your head. Focus on the sensations of tension and relaxation in each muscle group.

Why it helps: PMR reduces physical tension and stress levels. By systematically relaxing muscles, it encourages deep relaxation and improves sleep quality — essential for staying on track with your goals.

Incorporate these techniques into your daily routine to create space for mental wellness. By managing stress effectively, you support not only your mental health but also your physical well-being, making it easier to achieve and maintain your health goals. Gentle reminder: Take a moment for yourself today!

Try these tips throughout the week, then check in next week for more advice on protein intake, mobility, and when to take a rest day.

And don't forget to visit the gym and share your journey on Instagram for another entry to win a prize!* [Click here](#) for more information on prizes and sweepstakes rules.



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YOUR WEEK 3 TRANSFORMATION CHALLENGE LINEUP

[NAME],

You've completed two weeks of the Transformation Challenge, and you've got a serious groove going. Use the tips below to keep building on the progress you've already made! 🙌

🦋 TRAINING

Stretching and mobility training are often used interchangeably, but they play distinct roles in enhancing performance and preventing injury. Let's talk about the differences!

Stretching involves lengthening muscles to increase flexibility and range of motion. It typically means holding a position to elongate specific muscles and improve static flexibility.

Mobility training refers to moving a joint through its full range of motion actively and effectively. It emphasizes strength, control, and flexibility in dynamic movements that mimic real-life actions rather than in static positions to improve coordination and neuromuscular control. This translates to better performance in activities requiring agility and strength. It also helps prevent overuse injuries and promotes longevity in physical activity.

Some of the most important areas of the body to target for mobility training are:

1. Hips

Try this move: Quad hip circles

How to:

1. Get down to the floor on all fours.
2. Keep your hands under your shoulders and knees under your hips.
3. Keeping your hips level with the floor, lift your knee out to the side and draw a circle in the air.
4. Repeat for 20–30 seconds clockwise, then do 20–30 seconds counterclockwise.
5. Switch to the other side and repeat.

2. Shoulders

Try this move: Thread the needle

How to:

1. Begin on your hands and knees with your wrists aligned under your shoulders and your knees under your hips.
2. Slide your right arm underneath your left arm, palm facing up.
3. As you slide your arm through, lower your right shoulder toward the mat. Your right ear and cheek can rest on the ground.
4. Stay in this position for 20–30 seconds, focusing on relaxing and deepening the stretch in your shoulders and upper back.
5. Unthread your arm and extend toward the ceiling. Follow your hand with your gaze.
6. Switch sides and repeat.

3. Spine

Try this move: Cat-cow

How to:

1. Begin on your hands and knees with your wrists aligned under your shoulders and your knees under your hips. Your spine should be in a neutral position, with a flat back.
2. Inhale as you drop your belly toward the mat, arching your back. Lift your chin and chest toward the ceiling, allowing your gaze to lift upwards. This creates a curve in your lower back.
3. Exhale as you round your spine toward the ceiling, like a cat stretching its back. Draw your belly button towards your spine, tuck your chin towards your chest, and let your head drop toward the floor.
4. Continue to move between cat and cow poses, coordinating your breath with each movement.

Bonus: [Check out more of our Coaches' favorite moves.](#)

NUTRITION

Whether your Transformation Challenge goal is to lose body fat or gain muscle mass, protein plays a critical role in achieving both goals. Here's how it supports your body through your strength training routine:

Increased satiety: Protein helps keep you feeling full for longer. This can reduce overall calorie intake due to less hunger and prevent overeating to support fat loss.

Preservation of lean mass: During fat loss or periods of calorie restriction, there's a risk of losing muscle mass. Adequate protein intake helps preserve lean body mass by providing the necessary amino acids to repair and build new muscle fibers. This is also important for maintaining a healthy metabolism.

Increased strength and performance: Consuming enough protein is linked to improved strength and performance during resistance training. This can lead to more effective and efficient muscle development.

Amino acid building blocks: Proteins are made up of amino acids, which are the fundamental building blocks of muscle tissue. When you consume protein, your body breaks it down into amino acids. As noted above, this is how you build muscle!

Muscle protein synthesis (MPS): Protein consumption stimulates a process called muscle protein synthesis. MPS is the creation of new proteins within muscle cells, and it's key for muscle growth. Consuming an adequate amount of protein ensures that your body has the necessary amino acids to support this synthesis.

Muscle repair and recovery: Protein plays a vital role in repairing muscle fibers after resistance training, aiding in the recovery process that leads to muscle growth and strengthening.

Hormonal regulation: Protein intake influences the release of hormones like insulin and growth hormone — both play important roles in muscle growth. Insulin helps transport amino acids into muscle cells, while growth hormone stimulates muscle protein synthesis.

How much protein do you need? Reference your personalized macros from your Evolt scan for your target goal of protein or consult your Coach. For optimal fat loss and muscle mass development, it's essential to distribute protein intake evenly throughout the day and include a variety of protein sources in your diet.

We'll talk about easy ways to get more protein in (especially after a workout) next week!

RECOVERY

Knowing when to hit the gas and when to ease off can be the difference between progress and burnout (especially when you're putting in as much work as you are now!). You're more than two weeks into the Transformation Challenge — how is your body feeling? Use these tips to tune in and assess your needs:

1. Listen to your energy levels. ⚡ Pay attention to how you feel day to day. If you're constantly fatigued, struggling to get through workouts, or feeling unusually irritable, it might be a sign that your body needs a break.

2. Monitor your sleep quality. 🛌 Quality sleep is crucial for recovery. If you find yourself tossing and turning or waking up feeling groggy despite getting enough hours, it could indicate your body is under stress and needs more rest.

3. Track your performance and recovery. 📈 Notice if your performance in workouts is plateauing or declining, despite consistent effort. Difficulty in recovering between workouts, persistent soreness, or lingering injuries may signal that it's time to dial back and prioritize recovery.

4. Assess your mental state. 🧠 Stress and burnout aren't just physical — they affect mental well-being, too. If you're feeling unusually anxious, unmotivated, or experiencing mood swings, your body and mind may benefit from a break.

5. Embrace active recovery. 🚶 A break doesn't always mean complete rest. Incorporate active recovery days with lighter activities like yoga, gentle stretching, or walking. These can help promote blood flow, reduce muscle tension, and rejuvenate your body.

Remember: Taking a break isn't a sign of weakness — it's a smart strategy for long-term success. By tuning into your body's signals and prioritizing rest when needed, you set yourself up for stronger, more sustainable progress during the Transformation Challenge (and beyond).

You're on fire — keep up the good work and check your inbox next week for more pro tips from our expert Coaches!

And don't forget to visit the gym and share your journey on Instagram for another entry to win a prize!* [Click here](#) for more information on prizes and sweepstakes rules.



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YOUR WEEK 4 TRANSFORMATION CHALLENGE LINEUP

[NAME],

Three weeks down! You're halfway through the Transformation Challenge — but don't slow down yet. 🔄 We've got another week of Coach-approved training, nutrition, and recovery tips to fuel your journey.

🏋️ TRAINING

Staying consistent with your training routine can help you track improvements and build better form.

Even with a consistent routine, you can still spice up exercises with some minor variations. Use these tips to change up your routine and keep your workouts exciting without hindering your progress.

1. Change the plane of motion.

Most exercises operate in a single plane of motion, but diversifying can challenge your muscles in new ways.

Try this: Adding side lunges to your usual forward or reverse lunges engages different muscle groups and improves overall stability.

2. Adjust the timing of the movement.

Altering the speed of your exercises can significantly affect their intensity.

Slow down your lifts for 5–10 seconds for greater muscle engagement, or try explosive jump squats for a power boost. Play with eccentric (lowering down) and concentric (lifting up) phases for varied strength gains.

Push-ups are one of our favorite moves to play with. Try lowering down toward the ground with a standard two-second count and then slowly push back up for five seconds.

Try this: [17 Push-Up Variations to Switch Up Your Arm Workout](#)

3. Incorporate unilateral training.

Incorporating alternating single-leg or single-arm exercises — rather than bilateral movements (both at the same time) alone — can help build balanced strength and coordination while enhancing core stability.

Try this: Check out some of Coach Aaron's favorite unilateral moves!

NUTRITION

Having both protein and carbs after your workouts aids in muscle repair and adaptation and helps you feel more prepared for your next workout or activity — but how much do you need to get the best results? A 2018 study by Jäger et al. found that having at least 20–40 grams of protein post-workout was the best option for maximizing muscle protein synthesis (MPS).

Here are some examples of what 30 grams of protein might look like:

- 1.5–2 scoops of protein powder
- 1.5–2 cups of Greek yogurt
- 1 cup of cottage cheese
- 4 ounces of cooked meat or deli meat
- 4 ounces of jerky
- 4 ounces of salmon/fish/shrimp
- 1 can or packet of tuna
- 2 cups of edamame
- 2 eggs + 4 egg whites

Note: Brands and serving sizes can vary.

If you need some more inspiration, here are some quick and easy post-workout recipes that incorporate at least 30 grams of protein — try one after your next workout!

Protein shake:

- 1.5–2 scoops of protein powder
- 1 cup of mixed berries
- Medium banana
- Blend with water or milk of your choice

Greek yogurt parfait:

- 1.5–2 cups of nonfat Greek yogurt of choice

- Pinch of granola
- ½ cup of mixed berries

Turkey wrap:

- 4 ounces of deli turkey breast
- Whole-grain tortilla
- Add veggies like lettuce, tomatoes, and bell peppers
- Add condiments of choice

Salmon and quinoa bowl:

- 4 ounces of cooked salmon
- 1 cup of cooked quinoa
- Add steamed vegetables like broccoli and carrots

Tuna and chickpea salad:

- 1 can or packet of tuna
- 1 cup of chickpeas
- Mix with diced cucumbers, cherry tomatoes, and a light vinaigrette

Edamame and quinoa salad:

- 2 cups of edamame
- 1 cup of cooked quinoa
- Toss with cherry tomatoes, red onion, and a lemon-tahini dressing

Egg burrito:

- 2 large scrambled eggs + 4 egg whites
- 1 whole-grain tortilla
- Add sautéed vegetables like bell peppers, onions, and spinach
- Add hot sauce or condiments of choice

RECOVERY

Let's take a moment to celebrate the hard work you've been putting in — and the progress you've already made! That could mean weight loss, muscle gain, or a leaner body composition. But sometimes the biggest victories are the ones that you can't see on the scale.

Consider these non-scale victories as you reflect on your progress so far:

⚡ **Enhanced energy levels:** Enhanced energy levels often result from healthier eating habits and a balanced fitness routine. This boost in energy helps you push through intense workouts and even mundane daily tasks.

👍 **Improved range of motion:** Increased flexibility and mobility help you perform exercises with proper form, which reduces the risk of injury during strength training

and improves overall fitness.

🛏️ Better sleep quality: Regular exercise can help you sleep more soundly and get more restful sleep, which supports muscle recovery and growth, hunger regulation, and fat loss. Quality sleep is also essential for repairing and building muscle tissue after intense workouts.

🧘 Increased mindfulness and reduced stress: You may feel more present and focused during (and after) workouts, which enhances your performance, recovery, and connection with your body. Lower stress levels also help maintain motivation and adherence to your wellness routine.

By celebrating these non-scale victories, you not only acknowledge your progress but also reinforce a positive mindset, which is crucial for effective recovery. Every step forward — no matter how small — is a testament to your hard work and dedication!

Reminder: Keep up the good work, and don't forget to visit the gym and share your journey on Instagram for another entry to win a prize!* [Click here](#) for more information on prizes and sweepstakes rules.



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YOUR WEEK 5 TRANSFORMATION CHALLENGE LINEUP

[NAME],

You're getting so close to completing the Transformation Challenge. Keep up the good work — you can do it!

TRAINING

Between busy work schedules, vacations, and other plans, you've probably discovered over the past few weeks that sticking to your training plan can sometimes be easier said than done. But a busy schedule doesn't have to keep you from reaching your goals.

One of our favorite solutions? Resistance bands. They're an easy, portable tool for a full-body workout that fits right into your schedule so you can keep the progress going, whether you're busy at home or always on the go.

Here's what you need to know:

Resistance bands have various levels of thickness that correspond with the amount of resistance — the thicker the band, the greater the resistance. Consider these recommendations to optimize your workout:

- Always ensure there is tension in the band.
- Use lighter bands and focus on higher repetitions to increase calorie burn.
- Opt for heavier bands and incorporate slower, controlled movements to maximize muscle engagement.
- Avoid placing bands on joints like knees and elbows.

Try this Coach-approved full-body resistance band workout! [Follow along in the AF App](#)

1. Mini-band glute bridge

How to:

- Place the mini band above mid-shin and lie on your back with knees bent, feet flat on the floor at hip-width, and arms by your sides.
- Brace your core to hold the spine in a neutral position.
- Contract your glutes to lift the hips.
- At the top, your shoulders, hips, and knees should be in a straight line; push your knees slightly outward to keep the band tight and activate the gluteus medius.
- Lower your hips with control and keep the spine in a neutral position. Lightly touch your hips to the floor and repeat.

2. Mini-band push-up

How to:

- Place a mini band around your forearms to level up the standard push-up. Ensure there's tension in the band.
- Support your body on your toes and hands with your elbows bent and your chest nearly touching the floor.
- Push up to a straight arm position.
- Lower your body back to the start position and repeat, keeping your back flat and your hips in line with your shoulders throughout.

3. Overhead squat

How to:

- Use a resistance band with handles to practice proper posture during an overhead squat.
- Place your feet shoulder-width apart or slightly wider. Hold the band overhead with your hands wider than shoulder width.
- Send the hips back as you sit into a squat, maintaining your band in the same position overhead.

4. Reverse lunge

How to:

- Stand upright with one foot on the middle of the tubing, holding the handles at your shoulders with your elbows bent.
- Take a step backward, dropping your back knee to the floor and leaning your torso slightly forward with your weight on your front leg.
- Push off your front foot to return to the start position, keeping the handles at your shoulders throughout.
- Complete all reps on one side before switching to the other side.

5. Banded row

How to:

- Bend forward at your waist with your knees slightly bent and back flat. Stand in the middle of the tubing and hold the handles with your arms straight and palms facing in.
- Lift the handles to the sides of your chest.
- Lower the handles back to a straight arm position, keeping your back flat throughout.

6. Band pull apart

How to:

- Stand upright, holding the ends of a band in each hand with your arms extended out in front.
- Pull the band apart, bringing it toward you at the mid-chest.
- Lead the pulling with the shoulders retracting.
- Maintain a neutral, upright spine and keep your head still.

7. Banded arm circles

How to:

- Begin by standing upright in a neutral position, holding onto your resistance band with a wide grip, palms facing behind you.
- Slowly raise your band over your head, keeping your arms straight, and continue the rotation down and behind you. If this feels uncomfortable, start the exercise again with a wider grip or go as far as is comfortably possible.
- Rotate your arms back around to your starting position and then repeat the movement.

Want to try more moves? [Check out these options from Coach Nick](#) with an emphasis on upper-body strength.

NUTRITION

We get it: Alcohol can be a touchy subject, especially when there's so much social pressure around drinking. You've likely heard it before, but alcohol consumption can indeed affect your efforts to lose body fat or build muscle mass. However, if you choose to enjoy alcohol, consider these tips for doing so in a balanced way:

Set clear goals: Start by setting realistic goals for reducing your alcohol consumption. Whether it's having alcohol-free days during the week or limiting yourself to a certain number of drinks per occasion, clear goals can help guide your choices.

Plan ahead: Just like planning your meals, it's helpful to plan your drinks in advance. Liquid calories still count toward your daily calorie intake goals! Make sure to include plenty of water, veggies, lean protein, and other filling foods to stay within your daily intake goal (especially if you're in a deficit!).

Stay hydrated: Instead of alcohol, opt for hydrating alternatives such as infused water, unsweetened iced tea, or sparkling water with a splash of citrus when possible.

Explore zero-proof options: Sample non-alcoholic beverage products with friends or [experiment with these mocktail recipes](#).

Choose lower-calorie options: When you do choose to drink, go for lighter options. For example: Skip juice, added sugar, or frozen, blended mixed drinks. Instead, opt for sparkling water and fresh citrus like lemon or lime, which can add flavor without extra calories.

Drink mindfully: Savor each drink and drink slowly. Take breaks between drinks and alternate alcoholic beverages with non-alcoholic options to reduce overall consumption.

Plan alternative social activities: Instead of meeting friends at a bar or restaurant where alcohol is the central focus, plan social activities that don't revolve around drinking. Consider a coffee shop or outdoor activities like hiking, swimming, or picnics in the park.

Seek support: Share your goals with friends and family who can support your efforts to reduce alcohol intake. They can help keep you accountable and provide encouragement along the way.

RECOVERY

In addition to taking rest days (like we discussed a few weeks ago), the duration and quality of shut-eye you get every night have a significant impact on your energy levels, recovery, immune response time, hormone health, memory function, learning and information processing, and much more.

Getting fewer than 7 hours of sleep a night can negatively impact your progress on your health and fitness goals. Here's what to know, plus tips to stay on track:

Lack of sleep can cause a **change in hunger hormones**, making you feel hungrier and increasing cravings for foods that are higher in sugar, fat, and overall calories. Cravings can lead to eating habits that make it harder to lose weight. Longer waking hours may also lead to eating more meals and overeating.

Lack of sleep can cause a **reduction in testosterone and an increase in cortisol**, which inhibit the body from repairing and growing muscle. This means you could be in for poor recovery and fitness plateaus and can result in overtraining.

Lack of sleep can **increase feelings of fatigue, irritability, depression, and stress**, which can result in fewer training sessions, poor quality training, and decreased progress. If you're targeting fat loss, it also decreases the desire to move or exercise, resulting in lower overall calorie burn.

That's enough of the bad news...now, let's talk about **how to get better sleep!** Use these tips from the National Institute of Health to develop better sleep habits and stay on track with your wellness goals.

- Go to bed and wake up at the same time every day if possible (yes, even on the weekends).
- If you're not getting at least seven hours of sleep per night, try gradually adding 15 minutes to your normal sleep time until you reach a full seven hours.
- Get sunlight exposure throughout the day to help your body maintain a healthy sleep-wake cycle.
- Avoid caffeine in the afternoon and evening.
- Avoid alcoholic drinks for at least two hours before bed.
- Get rid of distractions such as noises, bright lights, digital devices, and work-related items before bed.
- Prepare your body for sleep by taking a bath, reading a book, or listening to relaxing music.
- Keep the temperature in your bedroom cool – between 65 and 68 degrees Fahrenheit.
- Use white noise to keep the sound environment consistent in your room.

Want more information? Check out these bonus resources from our friends at Stronger U:

- [Podcast: Importance of High-Quality ZZZ's with Dr. Shelby Harris](#)
- [Sleep & Stress Webinar with Stronger U Director of Nutrition, Jessica Bachman](#)

You're almost there...keep. pushing. One more weekly round-up, coming your way next week!

Psst...reminder: Book your final Evolt body composition scan to see your progress, and don't forget to visit the gym and share your journey on Instagram for another entry to win a prize!* [Click here](#) for more information on prizes and sweepstakes rules.



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YOUR WEEK 6 TRANSFORMATION CHALLENGE LINEUP

[NAME],

This. Is. It. You've reached the final week of the Transformation Challenge. First, pat yourself on the back for all the work (and sweat) you've already put in. Now, it's time for one last push to finish strong. 🏆 Let's do this!

TRAINING

As we wrap up the Transformation Challenge, it's time to revisit your Strength Assessment from Week 1. Repeating this workout can show you just how far you've come — and help you set your next goal.

By comparing your current results with your initial assessment, you'll gain valuable insights into your improvements and identify areas for continued growth. To review your results from Week 1, simply tap "History" in the AF App and scroll down to the first week of February.

While you're at it, go ahead and [schedule your final Evolt scan](#) to get a detailed picture of your progress and earn another entry to win one of the Challenge prizes!

After the Challenge wraps, you can continue crushing with your personalized plan in the Anytime Fitness App. If you want to level up your training even more, our Coaches have your back.

NUTRITION

After putting so much effort into the Transformation Challenge, you may be asking yourself, "What comes next?" You're not alone!

It can be easy to fall back into old patterns that slow down or reverse your progress. This often happens when the habits that led to achieving your goal in the first place

become inconsistent or stop completely. The first several weeks after achieving your goal are an important period that's often overlooked but can set the stage for what's next.

Being aware of a few common nutrition pitfalls can help you maintain a healthy balance and prevent setbacks after the Challenge wraps. Here are a few to keep in mind (plus how to overcome them!):

1. Neglecting nutrient balance

During the Challenge, you've been focused on your goals, and you may have even been tracking your food (or at least paying close attention to what you're eating). As you move into a more relaxed approach, staying aware of your food and eating habits is still beneficial. Maintaining a balanced calorie, protein, fat, carbohydrate, and fiber intake is crucial to support overall health.

Pro tip: Continue to be aware of the food you are eating, even if you aren't tracking. Working with a Coach to develop a plan based on your current needs can be beneficial in maintaining progress.

2. Lack of planning

Developing a structured routine, including meal planning and preparation, is common when working toward a goal. Once the goal is met, however, it might be tempting to abandon these habits, leading to inconsistent meals, choosing food options "on the fly," and an increased likelihood of making less nutritious alternatives.

Pro tip: Schedule a day or two each week to plan your meals, grocery shop (online shopping can help avoid impulse purchases in the store), and prep your meals for that week.

3. Skipping meals

A lack of planning or awareness about your daily nutritional intake can sometimes lead to skipped meals. PSA: Skipping meals does not automatically reduce your daily calorie intake! In fact, skipping meals can also lead to lowered daily diet quality (Zeballos et al., 2020).

Maintaining a proper daily energy balance has less to do with the number of meals you have and more to do with the number of calories and macronutrients you consume collectively throughout the day to support your energy expenditure (which is why tracking may be a good option for some).

Pro tip: Prioritize meal planning and preparation. Research shows that individuals who plan and prepare their meals are more likely to adhere to healthier dietary habits (Monsivais et al., 2014).

RECOVERY

This week, we're focusing on how to incorporate low-intensity exercise and activities into your recovery routine going forward. Recovery doesn't have to be a solitary or costly endeavor. In fact, combining active recovery with social activities can enhance

both your physical and mental well-being while keeping you on track with your fitness goals.

Turn your recovery into an opportunity to make social plans that align with your fitness journey. Consider these fun and healthy alternatives that help you recover and connect with others!

1. Go for a walk or hike.

Walks or hikes are fantastic for promoting blood flow and easing muscle soreness. They help maintain mobility and keep your muscles engaged without overexertion. Invite friends or family to join you. A casual stroll in the park or a scenic hike becomes a fun, bonding experience while you catch up and enjoy the outdoors together.

2. Join a group yoga class or stretching session.

Yoga and stretching classes are excellent for increasing flexibility, reducing muscle tightness, and enhancing relaxation while connecting with a friend.

Pro tip: [Activate your free access to Apple Fitness+](#) and do a yoga routine right in your living room.

3. Play a low-impact sport.

Engaging in low-impact sports like swimming, cycling, or even a casual game of frisbee provides a great way to stay active without straining your muscles. (Check out this [disc golf workout!](#))

4. Have a potluck.

Celebrate the end of the Transformation Challenge by enjoying a meal together with a focus on nutritious, recovery-friendly foods can be both satisfying and supportive of your fitness goals. (We've even got some [recipe suggestions](#) for you to try!)

Incorporating these active recovery options into your routine not only helps with physical recovery but can also boost your mood and strengthen your relationships. So, get out there, recover actively, and enjoy the company of those you care about!

REFLECTION

To close out the Transformation Challenge, take a few minutes to reflect on what worked, what didn't, and what you want to carry forward to set up healthy habits for life.

We've outlined a simple framework to help you be intentional about your next steps. Before you begin, grab a notepad and pen or pull up your notes app on your phone and follow the prompts.

Ask yourself these questions and write down your responses:

- Are your actions getting you closer to your goals?
- What habits did you implement to help you in your success?

- Can you maintain any of those habits or tweak them to suit your future goals better?
- Are there any new habits you didn't do before but would like to start now?
- How do you feel about your efforts in the challenge? Are they aligned with your desired results, or do you feel you could push harder or take it easier?

That's a wrap on your weekly Coaching tips! You're almost done with the Transformation Challenge — six weeks of pure effort and dedication to becoming your best self. WAY TO GO! 🏆 Don't forget to show off your hard work on Instagram and earn another entry to win a prize!* [Click here](#) for more information on prizes and sweepstakes rules.



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YOU DID IT!

[NAME],

Congrats on putting in serious work and finishing the Transformation Challenge! We hope this is just the beginning of your journey to your strongest, healthiest self.

While the Challenge has wrapped, you can keep the momentum going by setting new goals and leaning on our expert Coaches – and the Anytime Fitness App – for training, nutrition, and recovery support any day, anytime.

One last (big) thing: Remember those prizes* we mentioned? Here's a recap of how to make sure your name is in the hat:

- Share a picture or video of your Transformation Challenge experience on Instagram
- Use the hashtags **#AnytimeFitness** and **#sweepstakes** and follow [@anytimefitness on IG](#)
- Post by **March 27**.
- **You'll get one entry per post, up to 10 total entries.** (Note: Your profile must be public.)

Each entry is a chance for you to win one of these prizes:

- **Grand prize:** One 7-day trip for two to anywhere in the world where there's an Anytime Fitness.
- **Other prizes include:** Year-long Anytime Fitness memberships, recovery tools, AF swag and more.

[Click here](#) for more information on prizes and sweepstakes rules.

You deserve one big round of applause for the dedication you put into the Challenge.
Here's to even more transformative results! 🙌



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